Physical Activity: Educational Reference Notes

Physical activity includes movement produced by skeletal muscles that uses energy. Examples include walking, cycling, dancing, active play, gardening, and sports. Regular activity supports cardiovascular fitness, muscle and bone health, mood, and general wellbeing. Adults are commonly advised by public-health guidance to aim for at least 150 minutes of moderate-intensity aerobic activity across a week, or an equivalent amount of vigorous activity, alongside muscle-strengthening activities on two or more days. People who are inactive can begin with manageable amounts and increase gradually. Moderate activity usually raises breathing and heart rate while still allowing conversation. Reducing long uninterrupted periods of sitting and adding movement throughout the day can also be beneficial. Individual needs vary with age and health status.